

### 0.0.1 Passing Away as Devas

1. It so happened that the Auspicious One, having put a small soil on the tip of his fingernail, addressed the bhikkhus: “So what do you think, O bhikkhus, which is more? This small soil put on the tip of a fingernail by me, or this great earth?”

2. “This, O Bhante, is clearly more, namely the great earth. This is a trifle, insignificant, this small soil the Auspicious One has put on the tip of his fingernail. In comparison with the great earth, this small soil the Auspicious One has put on the tip of his fingernail does not even count, it does not even come close to comparison, it does not even approach part of a frac-

catutthadevacutisut-  
taṃ

atha kho bhagavā  
parittam nakhasikhā-  
yaṃ paṃsum ārope-  
tvā bhikkhū āman-  
tesi: "taṃ kiṃ mañ-  
ñatha bhikkhave, ka-  
tamaṃ nu kho ba-  
hutaram, yo cāyaṃ  
mayā paritto nakha-  
sikhāyaṃ paṃsu āro-  
pito, ayaṃ vā mahā-  
paṭhavī"ti.

"etadeva bhante, ba-  
hutaram yadidaṃ  
mahāpaṭhavī. appa-  
mattakoyaṃ bhaga-  
vatā paritto nakhasi-  
khāyaṃ paṃsu āro-  
pito. saṅkhampi na  
upeti, upanidhimpī  
na upeti, kalabhā-  
gampi na upeti, ma-  
hāpaṭhaviṃ upani-  
dhāya bhagavatā pa-  
ritto nakhasikhāyaṃ  
paṃsu āropito"ti.

tion.”

3. It is just so, O bhikkhus, few are those beings who when they pass away as devas, take birth among human beings. Rather, simply many are those beings who when they pass away as devas, take birth in hell. What is the reason for that? [Because of] the non-seeingness, O bhikkhus, of the four noble truths. Which four? The noble truth of suffering, the noble truth of the arising of suffering, the noble truth of the cessation of suffering, the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering.

4. Therefore, O bhikkhus, an endeavour should be made [to realize]: “This is suffering.” An endeavour should be made [to realize]: “This is the origination of

evameva kho bhikkhave, appakā te sattā ye devā cutā manussesu paccājāyanti. atha kho eteva bahutarā sattā ye devā cutā niraye paccājāyanti. taṃ kissa hetu? aditṭhattā bhikkhave, catunnaṃ ariyasaccānaṃ katamesaṃ catunnaṃ? dukkhassa ariyasaccassa dukkhasamudayassa ariyasaccassa dukkhanirodhassa ariyasaccassa dukkhanirodhagāminīpaṭipadāya ariyasaccassa.

tasmātiha bhikkhave, "idaṃ dukkhanti" yogo karaṇīyo "ayaṃ dukkhasamudayo"ti yogo karaṇīyo "ayaṃ dukkhanirodho"ti yogo karaṇīyo "ayaṃ

suffering.” An endeavour should be made [to realize]: “This is the cessation of suffering.” An endeavour should be made [to realize]: “This is the path leading to the cessation of suffering.”

dukkhanirodhagā-  
minī paṭipadā"ti yogo  
karaṇīyoti.

